

Class 7: Aspects of Social Movement Activity

Social movements and the media

Dr. Michael C. Zeller

Agenda for the day

- Opening notes
- Opening questions
- Poll: movements and media
- Movements and (traditional) media coverage
- Social movements and social media
- Movements, media, and astroturfing
- Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Opening notes

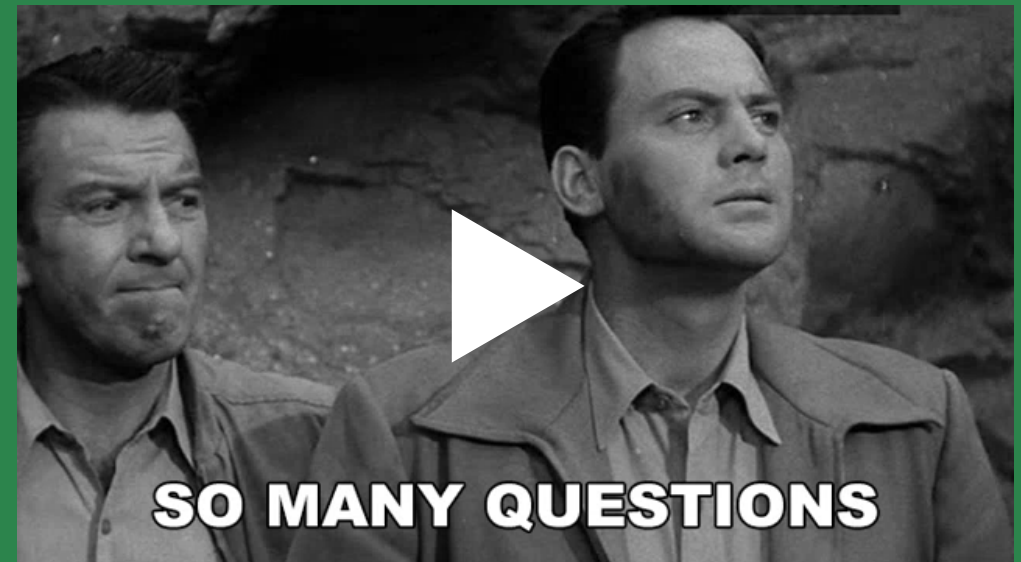


Presentations line-up

Date	Presenters	Method
4 Dec:	Daichi, Seongyeon, Jehyun	TBD
18 Dec:	Ayla, Tara, Theresa, Annabelle	TBD
15 Jan:	Luna, Emilene, Raffa, Sofia	TBD

Opening questions

- Where do you get your news?
- When you read the news (thinking only of 'traditional media' for the moment), what is reported, generally?



Media: the translator of social movements

What are the mechanisms of...

- movements advancing their **frames** (*Class 3*),
- **mobilisation, recruitment, participation** (*Class 4*),
- **tactics** and **strategies** achieving results (*Class 6*)?

often it is **the media** (including social media)

how media covers a movement is often how most people know about it

- **big practical and theoretical stakes**
- often plays a **gatekeeper** role

Past and present eras: a change of arena



The Great Barricade at the Entrance of the Rue du Faubourg St. Antoine, from the Place de la Bastille.



Past and present eras: a change of arena



The Great Barricade at the Entrance of the Rue du Faubourg St. Antoine, from the Place de la Bastille.



- previous eras: direct action, confrontation between movements and authorities more common
 - here: barricade in Paris, 1848
- modern era: indirect contention filtered through **media** more common
 - here: press pack ahead of movement press conference in Hong Kong
 - ‘the whole world is watching’ era
 - the **prospect** (for movements) and **peril** (for targets/authorities) now?
the whole world may be watching

Poll: movements and media



Take the survey at

<https://forms.gle/ngepuqqzaFu8nCfBA>

- ever personally supported a movement online?
- how do media generally portray *protesters*?
- what helped a movement get media coverage?
- should movements tailor their messaging/framing to gain more attention?
- does social media encourage 'slacktivism'?

- traditional media coverage still necessary for movements in an age of social media?

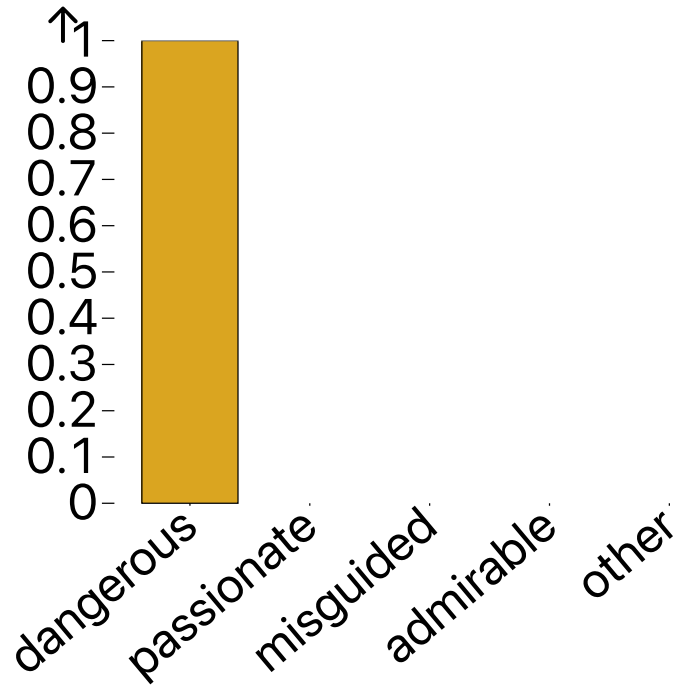
Questions about movements: (1) type of media most important for movement's visibility? (2) movement strategically plans actions to generate media coverage? (3) media coverage of movement generally favourable? (4) audience the movement mainly tries to influence? (5) movement often succeeds in getting its narratives into the media? (6) has the movement influenced public debate?



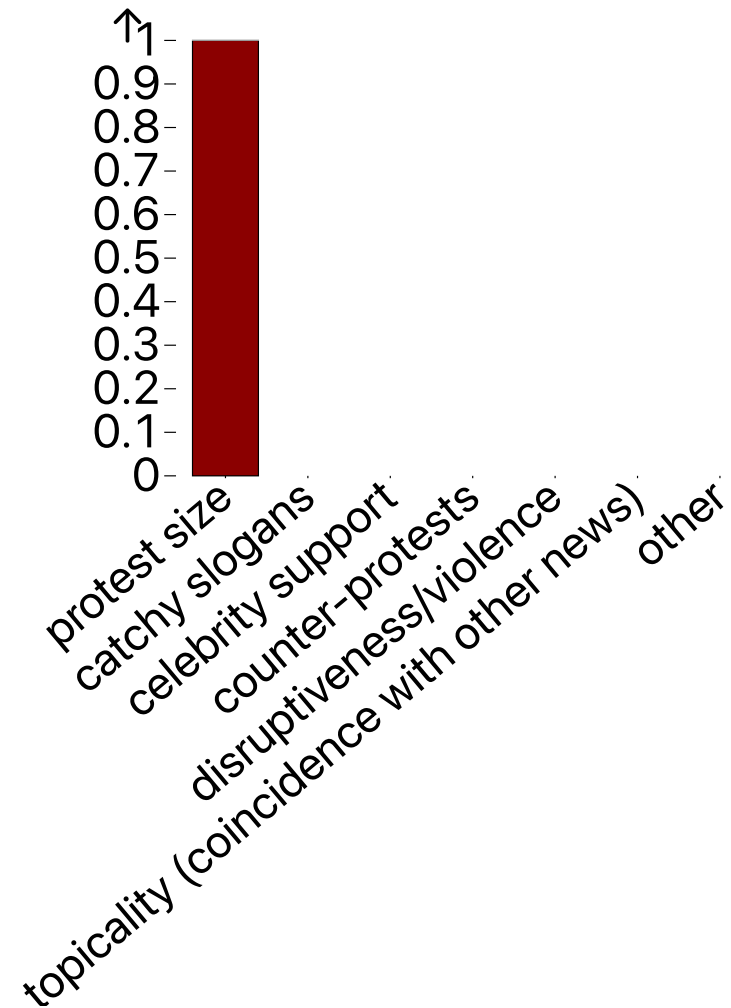
LUDWIG-
MAXIMILIANS-
UNIVERSITÄT
MÜNCHEN

Poll results (Respondents: 1)

how do media generally portray *protesters*?



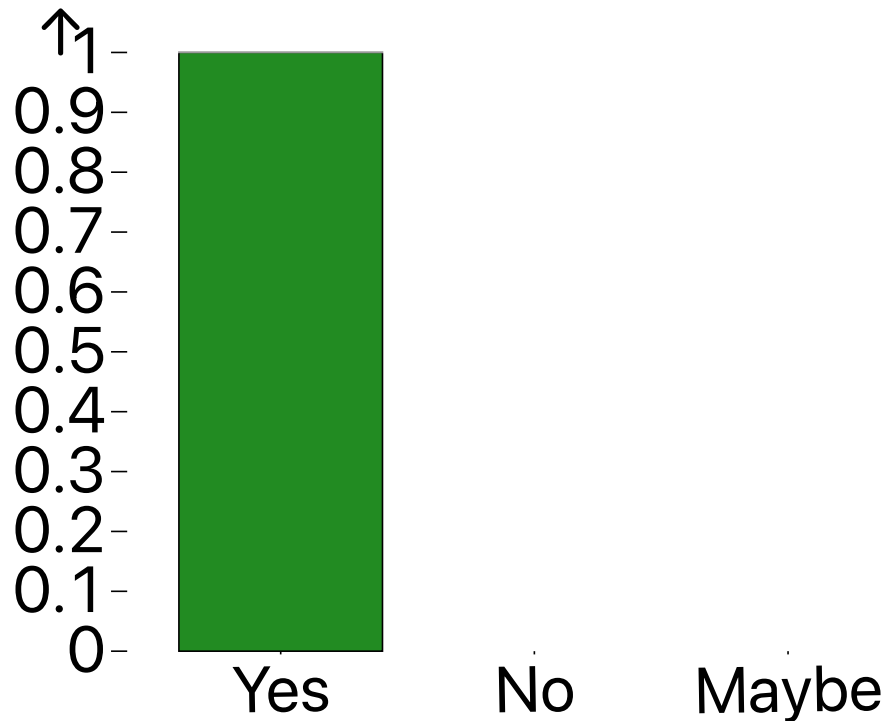
most likely to help a movement get media coverage?



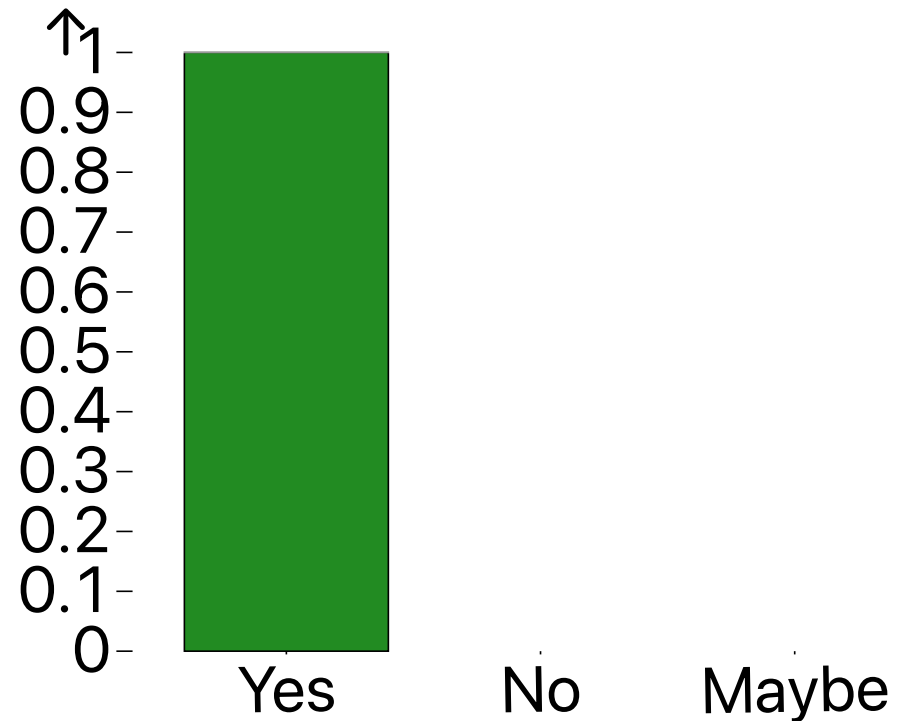
Poll results - boosting media coverage

Poll results - online

ever personally supported a
movement online?



does social media encourage
'slacktivism'?



Movements and (traditional) medicine coverage

- (some) factors influencing media coverage
- Jennings and Saunders (2019)
 - research questions, importance
 - data and methods
 - hypotheses
 - results



Movements and (traditional) media coverage

Factors that may affect media coverage

- day of the week (McCarthy, Mcphail, and Smith 1996)
- other news events (set number of 'column inches')
- weather (Madestam et al. 2013)
- celebrities (Atkinson and DeWitt 2018)
- size of event, violence/disruptiveness, whether there is a counterdemonstration (Denardo 1985; McCarthy, Mcphail, and Smith 1996; Biggs 2018)

Movements and (traditional) media coverage

Factors that may affect media coverage

- size of event, violence/disruptiveness, whether there is a counterdemonstration (Denardo 1985; McCarthy, Mcphail, and Smith 1996; Biggs 2018)
 - larger protests get reported – duh!
 - **media attention cycles** (*topicality*) (McCarthy et al. 1996)
 - if Germany's energy is in the news, then energy/climate protests may get more attention
 - **counterdemonstrations** may help attract more attention (media bias for '*both sides*')

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - RQs

- Why do some protests get reported on and others not?
- What protests get covered over the long term and why?
- Why? What's at stake?
 - **demonstrations** are **effective** when they not only hit newspaper headlines, but create a “**sustained shift in media focus, onto the issues that the demonstration raises**” (p. 2287)

- 48 street demonstrations in nine countries between 2009 - 2013
 - surveys – how do you think this is done?
 - Belgium, Czechia, Denmark, Germany, Netherlands, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, and United Kingdom
 - any important contextual considerations?

The design of our study is **large-N** (based on a sample of demonstrations, avoiding the tautology endemic to many studies of media attention to protest, which **select cases based on their being reported in the media**), at the same time as putting protest in context. (pp. 2293-4)

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - data and methods



Jennings and Saunders (2019) - hypotheses

Feature	Static	Dynamic
Number of participants	larger = more coverage	short- and long-term coverage
Contentiousness	high = more coverage	short- and long-term coverage
Exhibit violence	violence = more coverage	short-term coverage, long-term losses/costs
Trigger event	trigger = more coverage	short-term coverage

do these expectations make sense to you? do you disagree with any?

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - reg table

Table 3. Dynamic Model of Contextual Predictors on Media Coverage of Protest Issues.

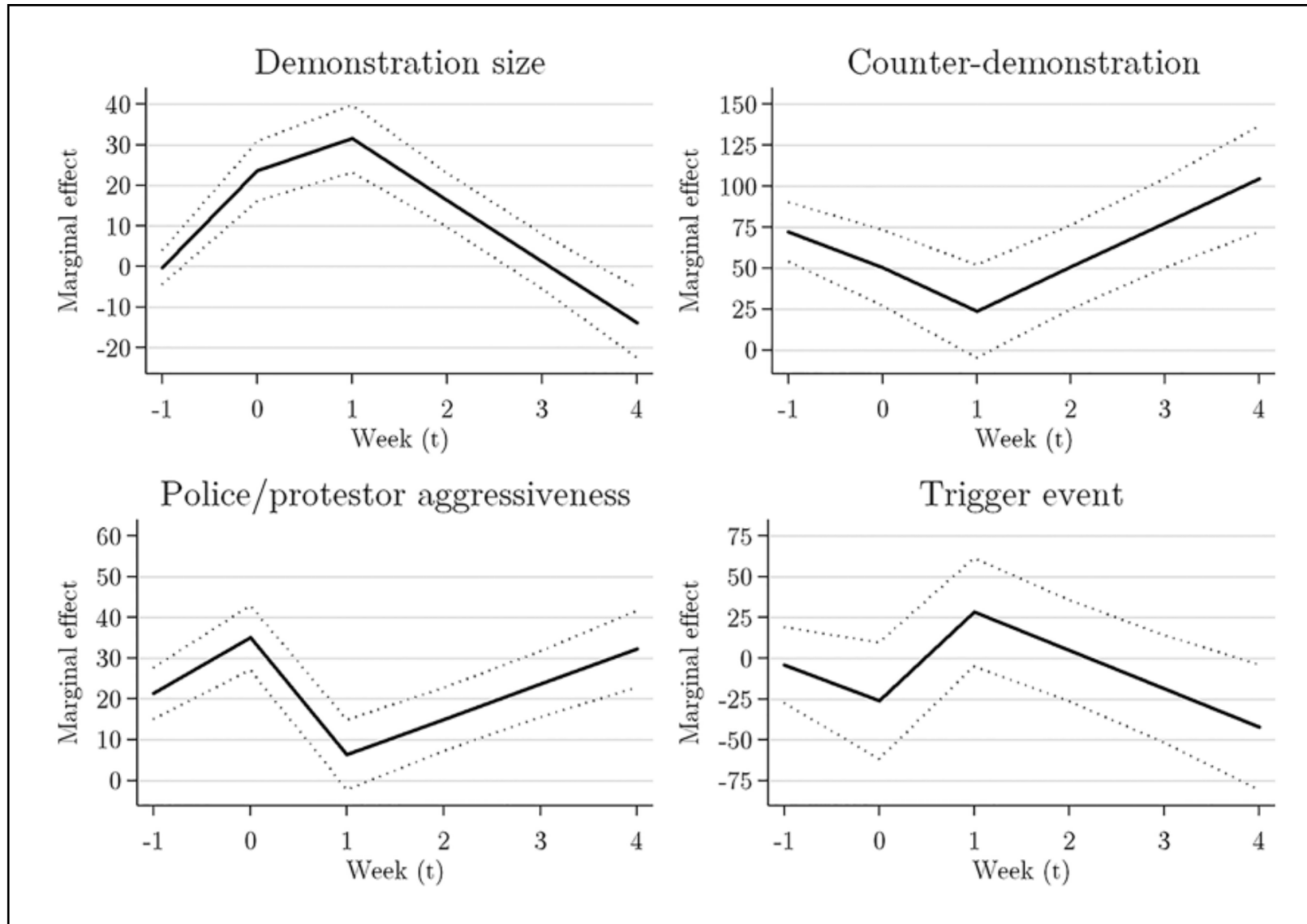
	MEDIA _{it}	
PULSE _{it}	16.73 (13.46)	7.25 (7.34)
STEP _{it}	73.08 (21.74)**	54.74 (11.03)**
RAMP _{it}	-21.91 (6.82)**	-13.65 (3.68)**
tone _i	10.01 (10.77)	15.41 (13.94)
size _i	2.26 (5.29)	-0.18 (4.16)
COUNTER _i	65.55 (10.75)**	72.25 (18.10)**
DEMPOL _i	27.28 (6.85)**	26.37 (7.81)**
TRIGGER _i	-7.00 (20.08)	-3.99 (23.29)
size _i × PULSE _{it}		23.74 (7.44)**
size _i × STEP _{it}		46.87 (11.41)**
size _i × RAMP _{it}		-15.14 (3.64)**
COUNTER _i × PULSE _{it}		-22.00 (21.89)
COUNTER _i × STEP _{it}		-75.41 (35.55)*
COUNTER _i × RAMP _{it}		26.93 (10.54)*
DEMPOL _i × PULSE _{it}		13.67 (5.99)*
DEMPOL _i × STEP _{it}		-23.72 (9.25)*
DEMPOL _i × RAMP _{it}		8.66 (3.05)**
TRIGGER _i × PULSE _{it}		19.75 (23.20)
TRIGGER _i × STEP _{it}		55.83 (38.03)

Reading a regression table

Remember: regression is a tool for understanding a phenomenon as a linear function (generally) $\rightarrow (y = mx + b)$

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - reg table

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - marginal effects



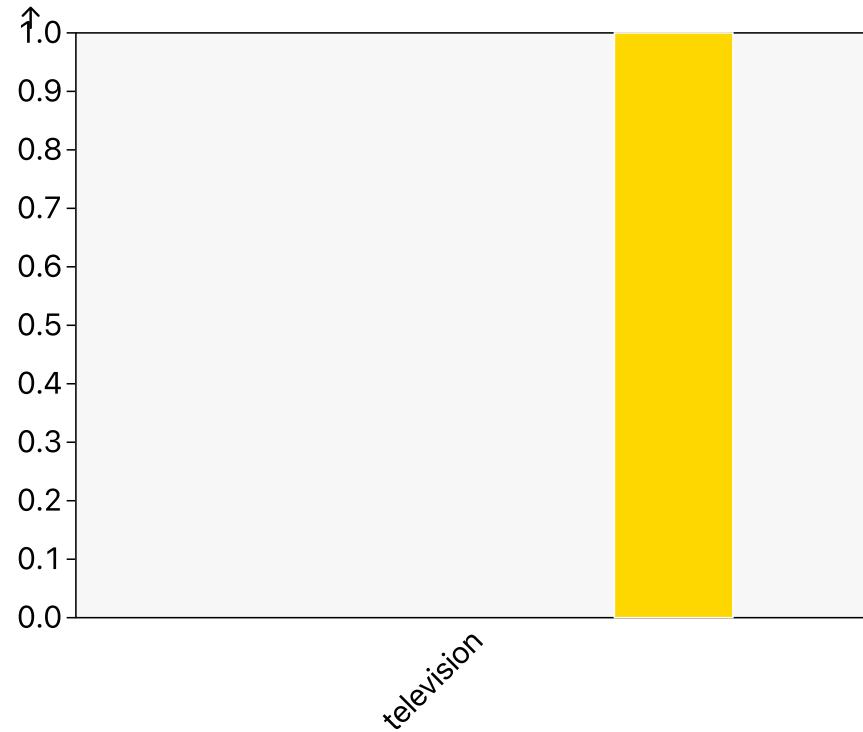
Jennings and Saunders (2019) - conclusions

- demos increase media coverage, **but** effect decays quickly
 - practical importance? **'strike while the iron is hot'**
- large size and police aggressiveness **increase** media coverage
- counterdemos *significantly reduced media coverage* of protest issues in longer term
 - puzzling finding

Movement responses - type of media

type of media most important for the movement?

■ Antifa ■ FFF ■ LG ■ PEGIDA ■ Identitarians ■ Querdenker

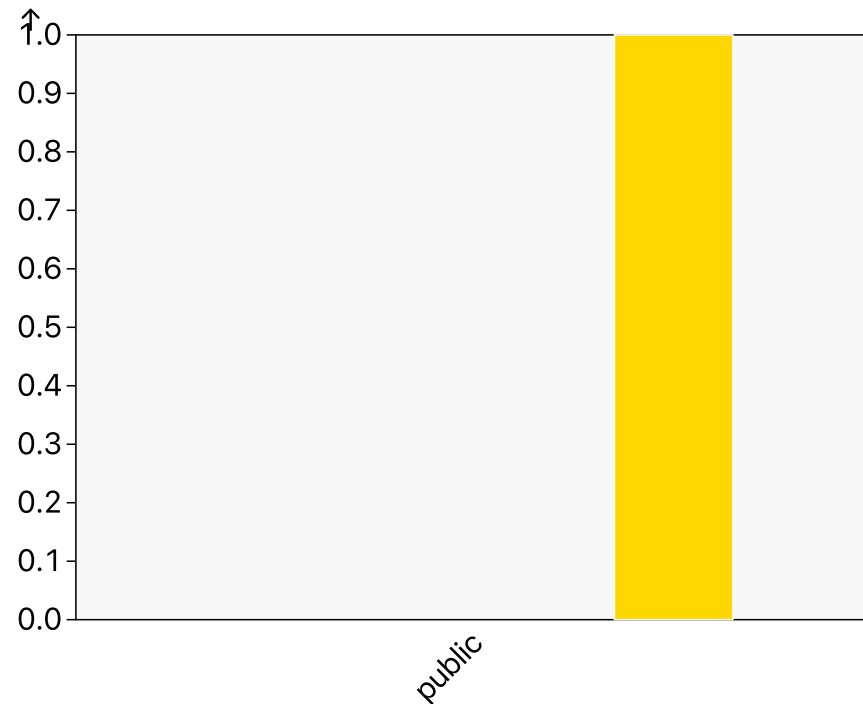


Movement responses - coverage

Movement responses - audience

which audience is the movement trying to influence?

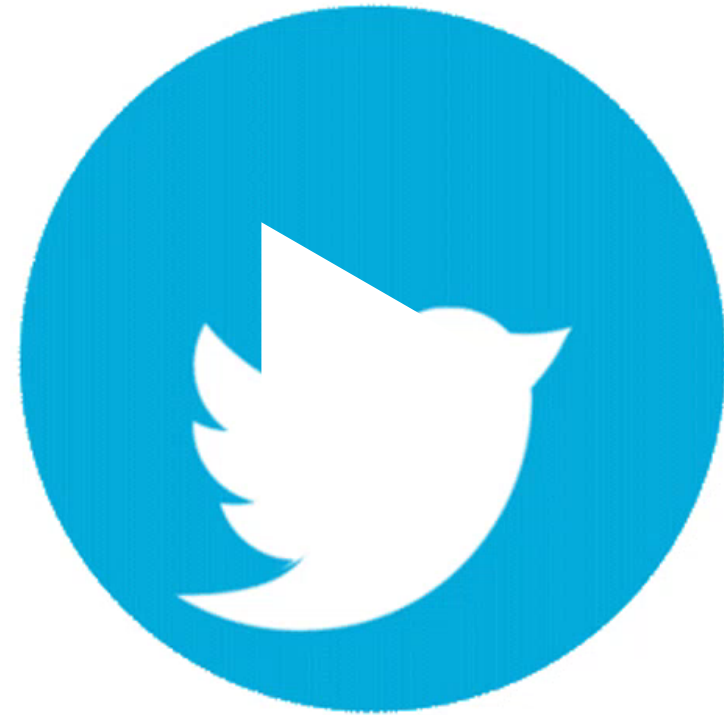
■ Antifa ■ FFF ■ LG ■ PEGIDA ■ Identitarians ■ Querdenker



Movement responses - media success

Social movements and social media

- from #hashtag to mobilisation
 - BLM example
- Slacktivism



From #hashtag to mobilisation

(USA Today on BLM)

From #hashtag to mobilisation

(USA Today on BLM)

social media breaks down traditional media **gatekeeper** roles

- helped BLM form **coalition** of K-Pop fans, Anonymous, celebrities, etc.
- enhanced BLM's 'narrative capacity' (i.e., efficacy in advancing **frames**, shifting status quo)
 - cf. 'disruptive capacity' and 'institutional/political capacity'

Movements and social media - revisiting a debate

Class 4: we listened to Tufekci and social media mobilisation and 'old-school organisation' - can attract more participants, but perhaps with less commitment

Movements, media, and astroturfing

- Torches of Freedom
- astroturfing
- knock-on effects



Torches of Freedom

1929, Easter Sunday Parade: a Tabubruch? more emancipation for women?



Movements, media, and astroturfing

astroturfing - manipulation of public sphere (media, information, movement scene)

- fake 'grassroots movements' are a common form of astroturfing
 - a way of harnessing the 'power of movement'
 - e.g., 'Tea Party movement' - a '*people's*' movement funded by Koch Industries
- any examples, instances of this in/around your case?

Torches of Freedom

Astroturfing: knock-on effects

- when movements are sometimes faked/manufactured, it undermines potential credibility of other movements
 - are people being ‘paid to protest’? who is ‘behind’ this protest?
 - questioning motives/genuineness of movements
 - **Letzte Generation:** funding from Climate Emergency Fund (U.S.), including Aileen Getty, heir of Getty Oil company
 - **Just Stop Oil (U.K.):** large amounts of funding from Climate Emergency Fund, from Dale Vince (green energy industrialist)
 - examples of conspiracy beliefs in U.S. (George Soros, Sandy Hook, etc.)

Any questions, concerns, feedback this class?

Anonymous feedback here: <https://forms.gle/AjHt6fcnwZxkSg4X8>

Alternatively, please send me an email: m.zeller@lmu.de

Questions about movements next meeting: (1) Is coalition with other movements important for this movement's success? (2) Has the movement participated in broad "umbrella coalitions" that bring together diverse actors? (3) Are coalition partners seen as temporary allies rather than long-term partners? (4) Do coalition actions tend to be more effective than solo actions by the movement? (5) Are the movement's coalitions are primarily local rather than national or

References

- Atkinson, Matthew D., and Darin DeWitt. 2018. "Does Celebrity Issue Advocacy Mobilize Issue Publics?" *Political Studies*, no. 2. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0032321717751294>.
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- McCarthy, John D, Clark Mcphail, and Jackie Smith. 1996. "Images of Protest: Dimensions of Selection Bias in Media Coverage of Washington Demonstrations, 1982 and 1991." *American Sociological Review* 61 (3): 478–99.